Value Proposition and the User

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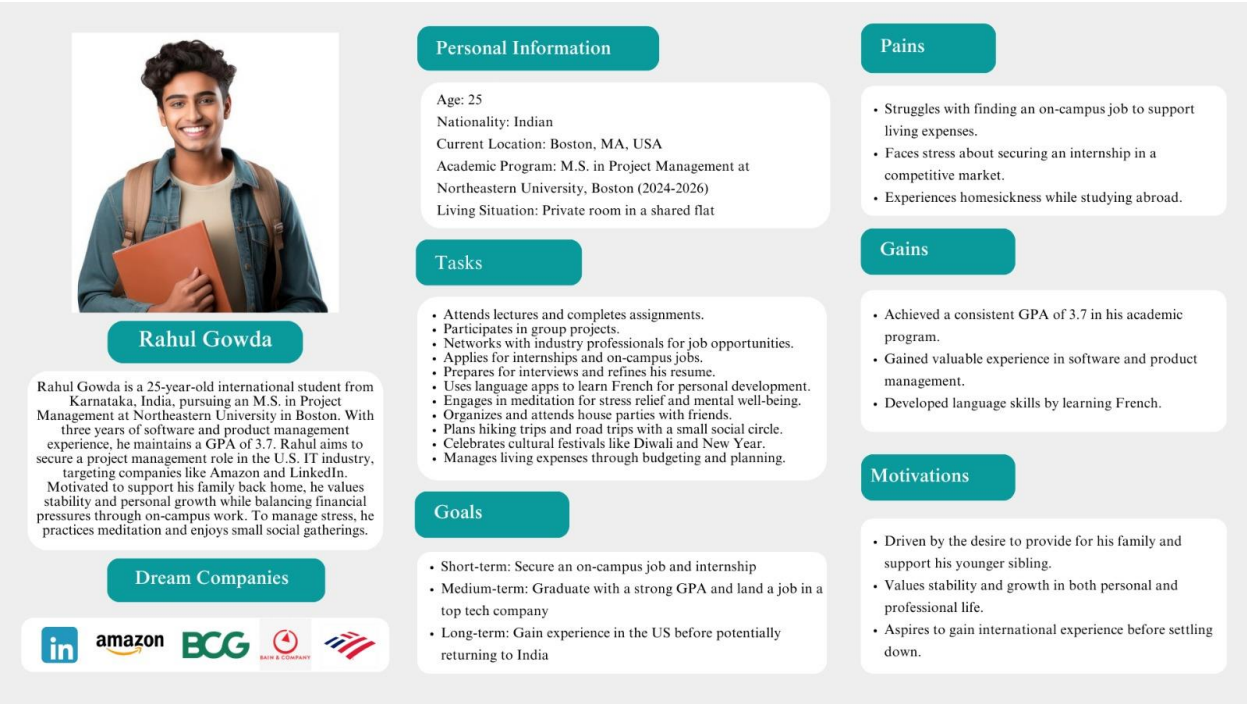
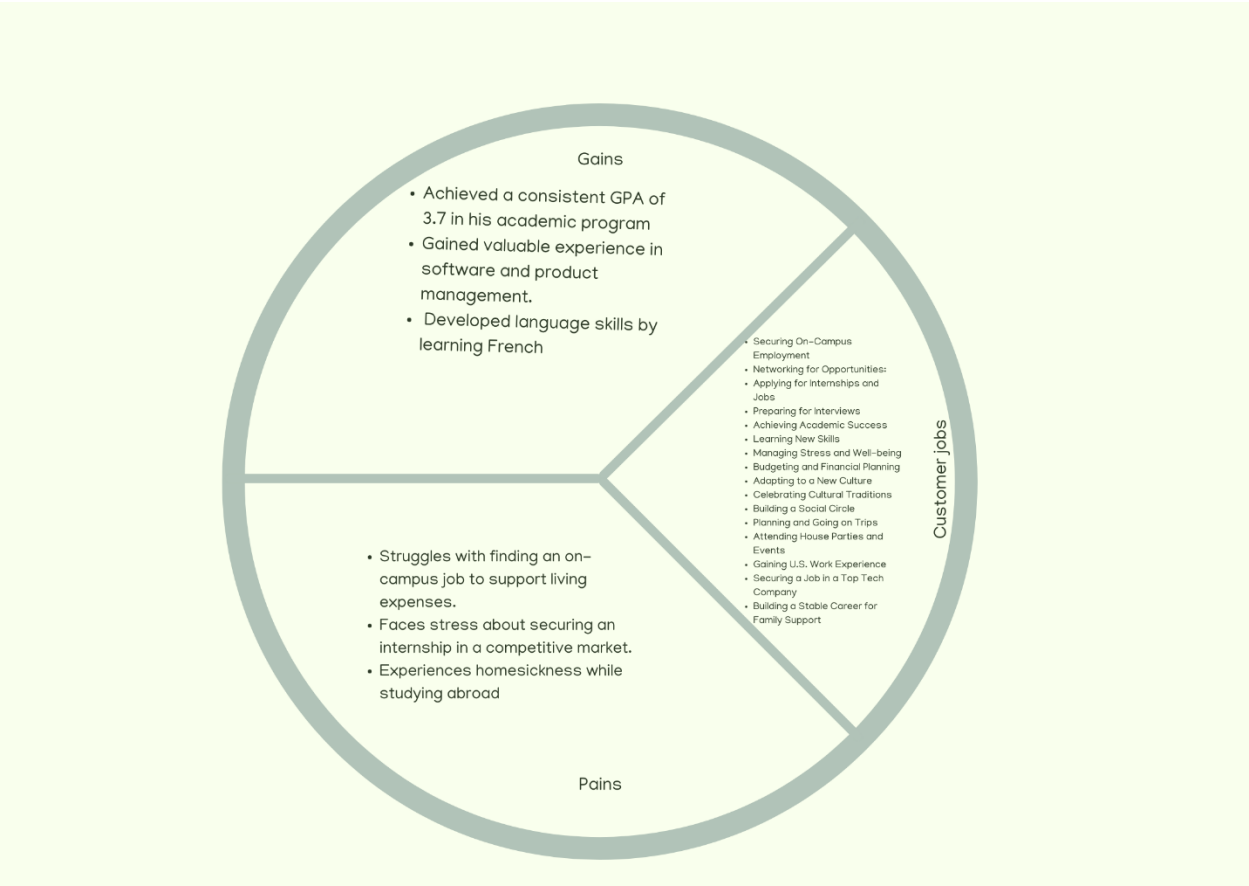
User Profile



We created our user persona by interviewing 20 students in the Project Management program at Northeastern University. Through informal interviews, we learned about their daily activities, challenges, motivations, and goals. We discussed their favorite courses, how they manage stress, and the financial pressures they face as international students. We also explored how they upskill themselves and maintain a social life. By analyzing their responses, we identified common themes and characteristics that shaped our persona. This persona, represented by Rahul Gowda, helps us better understand the needs and experiences of these students in both academic and professional settings.

Value Proposition Canvas



Achieving a consistent GPA of 3.7 demonstrates a strong commitment to academic success, which enhances employability and aligns with long-term career goals. However, securing on-campus employment has been a challenge, as finding a job that supports living expenses while providing relevant experience is crucial. Networking with industry professionals is another key strategy to enhance career prospects and secure internships, which are vital in today's competitive job market. Actively applying for internships and refining his resume and interview skills will further increase his chances of success. Additionally, learning new skills, such as improving French language proficiency, adds valuable assets to his profile, making him more competitive in the U.S. job market.

On a personal development level, managing stress is essential, especially while studying abroad. Engaging in activities like meditation and social gatherings can help maintain mental well-being.

Budgeting and financial planning are also critical for ensuring stability while navigating living expenses. Adapting to a new culture and managing feelings of homesickness are part of creating a sense of belonging in a foreign environment. Celebrating cultural traditions, like Diwali and New Year, helps maintain connections to his roots. Building a social circle through friendships and group activities balances the academic and personal aspects of life, while planning trips and attending events enriches his experience. Ultimately, gaining U.S. work experience and aiming for a position in a top tech company like Amazon or LinkedIn are steps toward building a stable career that can support his family back home and provide for his younger sibling.

Value Proposition Statement

Our career development platform helps international students pursuing graduate studies in the U.S.

Helps those who want to secure on-campus jobs and internships while managing homesickness and financial pressures.

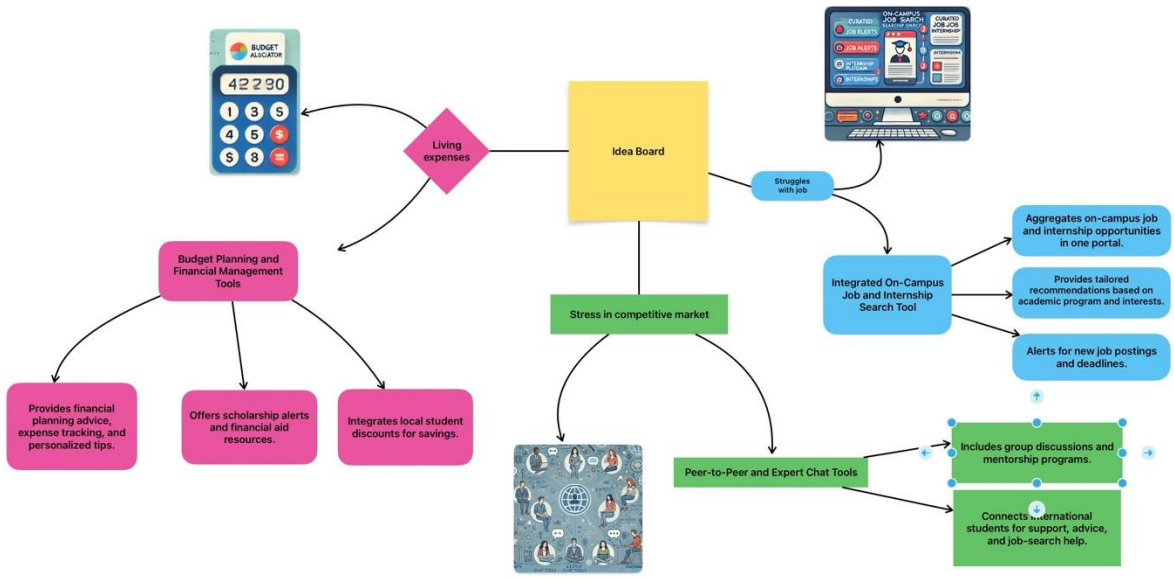
by providing guidance on job search strategies and budgeting support

and enhancing their network and social integration.

(**unlike** traditional career services that may not address the unique challenges of international students)

This career development platform stands out in the marketplace by specifically addressing the unique challenges faced by international graduate students in the U.S. Unlike traditional career services, which often provide general guidance, this platform tailors its resources to meet the distinct needs of international students who must navigate complex job markets, visa requirements, and cultural adjustments. By offering targeted job search strategies, personalized budgeting tools, and opportunities for social integration, it not only aids in securing on-campus jobs and internships but also supports students' emotional well-being and financial stability. This holistic approach helps international students build networks, manage homesickness, and feel empowered in their academic and career journeys—filling a critical gap in traditional career services.

Idea board



1.Integrated On-Campus Job and Internship Search Tool:

Description: A feature that aggregates and curates available on-campus job and internship opportunities in one easy-to-navigate portal. This tool would include tailored job recommendations based on the student's academic program and career interests.

Additional Feature: Alerts and notifications for new job postings and deadlines to ensure he stays updated.

2.Peer-to-Peer and Expert Chat Tools:

Description: A chat feature that connects users with other international students facing similar challenges, students who have already secured jobs, and employers from their home countries. This tool facilitates knowledge sharing, advice, and emotional support to help users navigate job searches and reduce stress.

Additional Feature: Group discussions and mentorship programs led by experienced students and professionals.

3.Budget Planning and Financial Management Tools:

Description: A budgeting tool that offers practical financial planning advice, expense tracking, and personalized tips to help manage living expenses. The tool can also include scholarship alerts and financial aid resources.

Additional Feature: Integration with local student discount programs and partnerships that offer savings on essentials.

References:-

Osterwalder, A., Pigneur, Y., Bernarda, G., Smith, A. (2014) Value Proposition Design: How to Create Products and Services Customers Want, John Wiley & Sons.